LINDEMAN (OPS-07) CASE BRIEF - ACTIVE, AGENCY-ONLY

Compiled 2026-10-11 from public reporting. All analytical product routes to McDonald County Sheriff's Office Dispatch: 417-223-4318. Never published.

VERIFIED FACTS (public record)

- Leo Lindeman (73), Katherine Lindeman (74), dog "Bitty" (small white indoor dog)
- Last contact: Sept 15 (Fox23) / Sept 16 (4029) - sources disagree; treat as Sept 15-16
- Reported missing: Sept 24 by neighbor who checked, found home empty, called 911
- Home: rural, off Highway 76 east of Anderson, McDonald County, MO (steep hollows, dense woods)
- Vehicle IN DRIVEWAY; only known cell phone + computer LEFT INSIDE
- Front door + windows open - but no AC, so this matches normal behavior (sheriff)
- ~20 dog teams searched property + adjacent areas: NO struggle, forced entry, or anomalies
- Neighbor security cameras: nothing suspicious
- Search warrant executed: electronics, fingerprints, trace evidence seized; financial records being pursued via warrants (bank activity NOT yet public)
- Family running search parties, dogs, private drone operator
- Sheriff Evenson: "It looks as if they just left"; open mind; "I wouldn't leave on foot"

HYPOTHESIS SPACE (deterministic triage)

H1 Voluntary departure (self-initiated, alive, avoiding contact)

- Against: no vehicle, no phone, elderly x2, small dog, 3+ weeks silent, steep terrain
- Requires: third-party pickup (which then IS the case) or on-foot (see H3) H2 Medical/wander event (one or both)
- Coupled case: one falls/injures, other stays or goes for help, both lost
- Dog stays with them - CONSISTENT with all physical evidence H3 On-foot misadventure (dog walk -> fall into hollow/creek)
- Bounded ONLY if departure was a single outing (hours). If unbounded (days), walkable radius explodes and H3 collapses by geometry H4 Third-party involvement, KNOWN to them (no struggle needed)
- Fits: clean house, clean cameras, "they just left"
- Discriminator: bank activity post-Sept 15 + phone/computer forensics (LE holds both) H5 Forced abduction by stranger
- Weakest vs. evidence: no struggle/trace after warrant search, clean cameras, 20 dog teams negative

THE SINGLE QUESTION THE EVIDENCE CANNOT CURRENTLY ANSWER

What rules out H2/H3 on-foot misadventure? The K-9 negatives are the hinge: were trailing dogs given scent articles + a start point, and did they work the ROADSIDE as well as the property? "No trail found" only counts if the method was valid. Request from LE: dog-team methodology + coverage map

of what was cleared. A confirmed negative trail + confirmed negative bank activity post-Sept 15 -> H4 becomes the leading deterministic hypothesis by elimination.

WHAT THE SYSTEM PRODUCES DETERMINISTICALLY (inputs = home location + terrain)

1. AOI + terrain: 3DEP/MSHP lidar for the Hwy-76 corridor; slope-cost surface (the hollows that make on-foot "difficult" per the sheriff are modelable).
2. Bounded-outing walkable donut: elderly pace 2.5-3 km/h, dog in tow, single-outing window -> search annulus; intersect with slope-cost and water (Big Sugar Creek drainage network) -> ranked hollow-bottom sectors. LOGIC: if cleared sectors stay negative, probability mass shifts to H4 by elimination - the map IS the argument to expand warrants, not vibes.
3. Egress analysis: road network reachable from the home without passing the neighbor cameras -> third-party pickup corridors.
4. Fusion priors: last-seen spike at home; K-9-cleared corridors de-weighted; water adjacency up-weighted (regional fall hazard).
5. Output: ranked sector map + a one-page "what to request from LE" list (dog method/coverage, financial warrant results when shareable, any license-plate reader or game-camera hits along egress corridors).

REQUESTS TO USER (to run the sectors)

- Their compiled GPS/candidate sites for this case (format: type, lat, lon, date, source)
- Property boundary + neighbor camera positions/orientations if in dossier
- The dossier's minute-by-minute Sept 15-16 timeline (who last spoke, how, what was said)
- What their "silent proof" consists of - one sentence, for the adversary pass